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California State Assembly, LA and Orange counties

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What does a state Assemblymember do?

The California Assembly is one-half of our state legislature. Along with the State Senate, it essentially serves as California's Congress. Voters will choose their representatives in all 80 state Assembly districts. Many will be new due to retirements and term limits, but how many challengers oust incumbents? And how many will flip from one party to the other?

The job duties include:

* Casting as many as 3,000 votes a year — and in theory a way most of your constituents want.

* Passing a state spending plan when there's likely to be a deficit and an uncertain financial picture.

* Sitting through long meetings, unless you get a spot on the powerful Appropriations Committee, where you'll decide behind closed doors and then pass or kill all the bills at once.

Find your district

Not sure who represents you in the California State Legislature? CalMatters has a tool for that. Just type in your address and look it up. (Don't worry — your address is not stored!) If you've voted in previous elections, your assembly district may have changed because of the redistricting process, which happens once a decade after the Census count.

You can also use this same tool to find out where your legislator lands on the "How liberal or conservative are your legislators?" scale.

Why do these races matter?

State lawmakers draft and pass laws that govern the entire state. These laws can provide benefits that aren't granted by the federal government, such as paid family leave or in-state tuition for undocumented college students. They can impose rules that apply statewide, like restrictions on buying guns, or not allowing restaurants to provide single-use plastic straws unless a customer requests it. They can also set minimum standards for the state and allow cities and counties to go further — for instance, the state minimum wage is $15 an hour for businesses with more than 25 employees, but the city of L.A.'s hourly minimum wage went up to $16.04 in July 2022.

There are 80 assembly districts across California, each with its own assemblymember. L.A. County alone has 24 of those districts. Each member serves two-year terms.

Around three-quarters of lawmakers in both California's Assembly and State Senate are Democrats, meaning the state doesn't just have Democratic majorities, but supermajorities. That doesn't mean it's always easy to pass bills, though. There are still divisions among lawmakers that lead to drawn-out arguments and prevent legislation from moving forward.

You might recognize their work from ...

In recent years, the legislature has:

* Passed a bill (signed into law in 2021) to make ethnic studies a graduation requirement for California high schoolers

* Passed a bill (signed into law in 2021) allowing duplexes to be built on single-family home lots, effectively ending single-family zoning

* Passed a bill (signed into law in 2020) to create a task force to determine how the state might deliver reparations to Black descendants of enslaved people

What's on the agenda for the next term?

California has a lot of problems to tackle — wildfires, climate change, the highest poverty rate in the country, and skyrocketing housing prices, and falling enrollment in public schools and community colleges, to name a few. The legislature will have to figure out ways to address all of these issues and accommodate whatever new problems may arise.

Rank-and-file Assemblymembers are paid $128,215 a year, plus $214 a day for expenses when the Legislature is in session. Party leaders get higher pay.

The candidates

This guide lists races across Los Angeles and Orange counties, and includes voter registration figures from earlier this year. Names appear in the same order as the certified list of candidates.

District 34

At a glance: This northern Los Angeles County district includes parts of Lancaster and Palmdale.

Voter registration: 39% Republican, 31% Democrat, 19% no party preference

Ricardo Ortega

Los Angeles County Youth Commissioner, Democrat

Website: RicardoOrtegaForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Tom Lackey (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Republican

Website: LackeyForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 39

At a glance: The district Lake Los Angeles, Lancaster, Littlerock, Palmdale, Sun Village, part of Los Angeles and stretches into San Bernardino County.

Voter registration: 46% Democrat, 22% Republican, 22% no party preference

Juan Carrillo Ventura (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: VoteJuanCarrillo.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Paul Andre Marsh

Community services liaison, Republican

Website: PaulMarshForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 40

At a glance: The district includes Castaic, Hasley Canyon, parts of Los Angeles, Santa Clarita, Stevenson Ranch and Val Verde.

Voter registration: 42% Democrat, 29% Republican, 21% no party preference

Pilar Schiavo (Incumbent)

State Assemblywoman, Democrat

Website: Pilar4CA.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Patrick Lee Gipson

Retired deputy sheriff, Republican

Website: Gipson4Assembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 41

At a glance: The district includes Altadena, Bradbury, Claremont, Duarte, La Cañada Flintridge, La Verne, Monrovia, Pasadena, San Dimas, San Pasqual, Sierra Madre, part of Los Angeles, and also extends into San Bernardino County.

Voter registration: 45% Democrat, 27% Republican, 19% no party preference

John Harabedian

California state boardmember, Democrat

Website: JohnHarabedian.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Michelle Del Rosario Martinez

Community Volunteer, Republican

Website: Linktr.ee/MDM4AD41

More voter resources:

* Guide To The State Assembly District 41 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 42

At a glance: This district includes Agoura Hills, Bel Air, Beverly Glen, Brentwood, Casa Conejo, Calabasas, Hidden Hills, Lake Sherwood, Malibu, Moorpark, Oak Park, Pacific Palisades, Santa Susana, Simi Valley, Thousand Oaks, Topanga, Westlake Village and stretches into Ventura County.

Voter registration: 41% Democrat, 30% Republican, 20% no party preference

Jacqui Irwin (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: JacquiIrwin.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Ted Nordblum

Local small businessman, Republican

Website: TedNordblum.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 43

At a glance: This district in the eastern San Fernando Valley is up for grabs after the incumbent, Luz Rivas, a Democrat, announced she would run for Congress.

Voter registration: 54% Democrat, 24% no party preference, 14% Republican

Celeste Rodriguez

San Fernando Mayor, Democrat

Website: CelesteForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Victoria Garcia

Councilwoman / attorney / mother, Republican

Website: VictoriaForCA.com

Endorsements: Full list here

More voter resources:

* Guide To The State Assembly District 43 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 44

At a glance: This district includes Burbank, La Crescenta-Montrose, parts of Glendale and Los Angeles.

Voter registration: 50% Democrat, 23% no party preference, 19% Republican

Nick Schultz

Deputy Attorney General, Democrat

Website: VoteNickSchultz.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Tony Rodriguez

Construction regional manager, Republican

Website: Tony4California.us

Endorsements: Full list here

More voter resources:

* Guide To The State Assembly District 44 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 46

At a glance: This district straddles the 101 Freeway and stretches into Ventura County.

Voter registration: 50% Democrat, 22% no party preference, 19% Republican

Jesse Gabriel (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: JesseGabriel.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Tracey Schroeder

Teacher, Republican

Website: TraceySchroeder.com

District 48

At a glance: This district includes Azusa, Baldwin Park, Charter Oak, Citrus, Covina, Duarte, Glendora, Irwindale, Mayflower Village, Monrovia, South Monrovia Island, South San Jose Hills, Valinda, Vincent, West Covina, West Puente Valley and part of Los Angeles.

Voter registration: 47% Democrat, 22.4% no party preference, 22.1% Republican

Blanca Rubio (Incumbent)

State Assemblywoman / teacher, Democrat

Website: BlancaRubio.com

Dan T. Tran

Real estate businessman, Republican

Website: DanTranForDistrict48.com

More voter resources:

* 5 Races To Watch California's Independent Voters (IVN News)

District 49

At a glance: This district includes Alhambra, Arcadia, East Pasadena, East San Gabriel, El Monte, Monterey Park, North El Monte, Rosemead, San Gabriel, San Marino, South Pasadena, South San Gabriel, Temple City and part of Los Angeles.

Voter registration: 45% Democrat, 29% no party preference, 18% Republican

Mike Fong (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: MikeFong.org

Long "David" Liu

Father / attorney / businessman, Republican

Website: DavidLiuForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 51

At a glance: This district stretches up from Santa Monica and includes part of Los Angeles, Beverly Hills and West Hollywood.

Voter registration: 58% Democrat, 22% no party preference, 12% Republican

Rick Chavez Zbur (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: RickChavezZbur.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Stephan Hohil

Entrepreneur, Republican

Website: StephanHohil.com

District 52

At a glance: This district includes part of Los Angeles, East Los Angeles, and part of Glendale.

Voter registration: 61% Democrat, 21% no party preference, 10% Republican

Jessica Caloza

Women's rights advisor, Democrat

Website: JessicaCaloza.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Franky Carrillo

Justice advocate / commissioner, Democrat

Website: FrankyCarrillo.com

Endorsements: Full list here

More voter resources:

* Guide To The State Assembly District 52 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 53

At a glance: This district includes part of Los Angeles, Pomona, Chino, Montclair, Ontario, Upland and part of San Bernardino. The incumbent, Freddie Rodriguez, a Democrat, is vacating the seat due to term limits. His wife is running to succeed him.

Voter registration: 46% Democrat, 22.7% Republican, 22% no party preference

Michelle Rodriguez

Public safety commissioner, Democrat

Website: MichelleForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Nick Wilson

Law enforcement educator, Republican

Website: NickWilsonCA.com

Endorsements: Full list here

More voter resources:

Guide To The State Assembly District 53 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 54

At a glance: This district includes Boyle Heights, DTLA and Koreatown.

Voter registration: 58% Democrat, 23% no party preference, 11% Republican

Mark Gonzalez

District director / caregiver, Democrat

Website: MarkGonzalezForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

John K. Yi

Public transit advocate, Democrat

Website: JohnForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

More voter resources:

* Who will be Assembly District 54's next representative? (Boyle Heights Beat)

* Guide To The State Assembly District 54 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 55

At a glance: This district includes Culver City, Ladera Heights, View Park-Windsor Hills and part of Los Angeles.

Voter registration: 64% Democrat, 19% no party preferred, 8% Republican

Isaac G. Bryan (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: IsaacBryanForCA.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Keith G. Cascio

Software developer, Republican

Website: KeithFor55.org

Endorsements: Full list here

District 56

At a glance: This district includes Avocado Heights, Diamond Bar, El Monte, Hacienda Heights, Industry, La Habra Heights, La Puente, Rico Rivera, Rose Hills, Rowland Heights, South El Monte, Walknut, West Whittier, Whittier and part of Los Angeles.

Voter registration: 48% Democrat, 24% no party preferred, 21% Republican

Lisa Calderon (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember / mom, Democrat

Website: LisaCalderon4Assembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Jessica Martinez

Educator, wife, mother, Republican

Website: @MartinezForAssembly

District 57

At a glance: This LA district straddles the 110 Freeway heading into DTLA.

Voter registration: 61% Democrat, 22% no party preference, 7% Republican

Sade Elhawary

Educator / community organizer, Democrat

Website: SadeForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Efren Martinez

Education commissioner / businessman, Democrat

Website: EfrenMartinez.com

Endorsements: Full list here

More voter resources:

* Guide To The State Assembly District 57 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 59

At a glance: This district includes Orange and San Bernardino counties and includes the cities of Anaheim Hills, Brea, Chino, Chino Hills, Fullerton, North Tustin, Orange, Placentia, Villa Park, and Yorba Linda.

Voter registration: 39% Republicans, 32% Democrats, 21% no party preference

Dave Obrand

Deputy County Counsel, Democrat

Website: DaveObrandForAssembly

Phillip Chen (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember / business owner, Republican

Website: PhillipChen.org

District 61

At a glance: This district includes Del Aire, Gardena, Hawthorne, Inglewood, Lennox, part of Los Angeles, Marina del Rey, West Athens and Westmont.

Voter registration: 61% Democrat, 20% no party preference, 9% Republican

Tina Simone McKinnor (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: Tina4CA.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Alfonso Hernandez

Restauranteur / coach / councilmember, Republican

Website: Hernandez4Assembly2024

District 62

At a glance: This district includes Bellflower, Huntington Park, Lakewood, Lynwood, Maywood, Paramount, South Gate, Walnut Park and part of Los Angeles. The seat is being vacated by outgoing Assembly Speaker Anthony Rendon.

Voter registration: 55% Democrat, 21% no party preference, 15% Republican

José Luis Solache

Mayor of Lynwood, nonprofit director, Democrat

Website: SolacheForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Paul Jones

Retired combat Marine, Republican

Website: PaulJonesForStateAssembly2024.com

Endorsements: Full list here

More voter resources:

* Guide To The State Assembly District 62 Race (Los Angeles Times)

District 64

At a glance: This district includes Bell, Bell Gardens, Cudahy, Downey, East Whittier, La Mirada, Norwalk, Santa Fe Springs, South Whittier, part of Los Angeles and La Habra.

Voter registration: 50% Democrat, 21% Republican, 21% no party preference

Blanca Pacheco (Incumbent)

State Assemblywoman, Democrat

Website: PachecoForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Raul Ortiz Jr.

Pest control manager, Republican

Website: RaulOrtizForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 65

At a glance: This district includes Carson, Compton, West Carson, East Rancho Dominguez and Willowbrook.

Voter registration: 58% Democrat, 11% Republican, 21% no party preference

Mike Gipson (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: MikeGipson.net

Endorsements: Full list here

Lydia A. Gutierrez

Public school teacher, Republican

Website: @Lydia4Assembly

District 66

At a glance: This district includes El Segundo, Gardena, Hermosa Beach, Lomita, Manhattan Beach, Palos Verdes Estates, Rancho Palos Verdes, Redondo Beach, Rolling Hills, Rolling Hills Estates, San Pedro and Torrance.

Voter registration: 44% Democrat, 26% Republican, 22% no party preference

Al Muratsuchi (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: AlForAssembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

George Barks

Business owner, Republican

Website: VoteForGeorgeBarks.com

District 67

At a glance: This district covers parts of L.A. and Orange counties, including Anaheim, Artesia, Cerritos, Cypress, Buena Park, Fullerton, Hawaiian Gardens and La Palma.

Voter registration: 43% Democrats, 26% Republicans, 24% no party preference

Sharon Quirk-Silva (Incumbent)

State Assemblywoman, Democrat

Website: SharonQuirkSilva.com

Elizabeth "Beth" Culver

Retired entrepreneur, Republican

Website: Ballotpedia

District 68

At a glance: This district includes parts of Anaheim, Santa Ana, Orange and unincorporated Orange County.

Voter registration: 49% Democrats, 22% no party preference, 21% Republicans

Avelino Valencia (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: AvelinoValencia.com

Mike Tardif

Retired businessman, Republican

Website: CAFamilyVoter.com

District 69

At a glance: This district includes Avalon, Signal Hill and much of Carson and Long Beach. See how district boundaries have changed.

Voter registration: 52% Democrats, 17% Republicans, 21% no party preference

Josh Lowenthal (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember and business owner, Democrat

Website: JoshLowenthal.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Joshua Rodriguez

Police Officer / father, Republican

Website: @JoshuaRodriguez4Assembly69

District 70

At a glance: This district includes Fountain Valley, Garden Grove, Los Alamitos, Midway City, Rossmoor, Stanton, Westminster, and portions of Huntington Beach, Santa Ana and Seal Beach.

Voter registration: 37% Democrats, 33% Republicans, 24% no party preference

Jimmy D. Pham

Attorney / business owner, Democratic

Website: JimmyPhamCA.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Tri Ta (Incumbent)

California Assemblyman / businessman, Republican

Website: TriTa4Assembly.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 71

At a glance: This district includes Mission Viejo and Rancho Santa Margarita and unincorporated parts of Orange County, as well as parts of Riverside County.

Voter registration: 40% Republicans, 30% Democrats, 20% no party preference

Gary Kephart

Software engineer, Democrat

Website: GaryKephart.com

Kate Sanchez (Incumbent)

State Assemblywoman, Republican

Website: SanchezForAssembly.com

District 72

At a glance: This coastal district includes Huntington Beach, Newport Beach and Laguna Beach.

Voter registration: 39% Republicans, 32% Democrats, 21% no party preference

Dom Jones

Nonprofit executive / businesswoman, Democrat

Website: DomJones.org

Endorsements: See full list here

Diane Dixon (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Republican

Website: DianeDixonForAssembly.com

Endorsements: See full list here

District 73

At a glance: This district includes Irvine, Costa Mesa and Tustin.

Voter registration: 40% Democrats, 27% Republicans, 26% no party preference

Cottie Petrie-Norris (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Democrat

Website: Cottie.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Scotty Peotter

Architect, Republican

Website: TaxFighter.com

Endorsements: Full list here

District 74

At a glance: This district includes Laguna Niguel, San Juan Capistrano, Dana Point, San Clemente and Camp Pendleton.

Voter registration: 35% Democrats, 34% Republicans, 21% no party preference

Laurie Davies (Incumbent)

State Assemblymember, Republican

Website: DaviesForCA.com

Endorsements: Full list here

Chris Duncan

San Clemente councilmember, Democrat

Website: VoteChrisDuncan.com

Endorsements: Full list here

More reading

* California Politics & Policy: A Primer (CalMatters): An overview of what our state government accomplished in 2021, and developments in major issues from housing to education.

* How Diverse Is The California Legislature? (CalMatters): An interactive tool that lets you input your demographic information — including age, gender, sexual orientation and income — and see how well our state lawmakers reflect those traits.

LAist staff also contributed to this report.

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